

the amount and position of electrons on the screen, it became possible to produce some pretty crazy patterns on a screen. For a long time, the use of CRTs was mainly restricted to experimental physics and chemistry, but in 1907, Russian scientist Boris Rosing explored the possibility of displaying simple geometrical shapes by using a CRT as a display.



An early CRT device

Spurred by Boris's work, early pioneers started incorporating higher degrees of complexity in the CRTs to try and obtain greater resolution of images. The first televisions combined the growing complexity of CRTs with the now eponymous Nipkow disk, a semi mechanical contraption that could scan an image and reduce it to a series of dots and lines. With a Nipkow disk, a pair of needles, a pair of scissors, a hatbox, and some smart tinkering, Baird successfully developed the first television in 1923. The first monochrome images displayed by these primitive displays were blurry, pixelated and very laggy, but they were still all the impetus needed for an entire industry to crop up to capitalise on humanity's growing fascination with images.

Bringing the TV Home: The first couch potatoes

The growing popularity of Hollywood was a major catalyst as well. People really wanted to bring all of the glamour and excitement of the movie